

# Android shim (VpnService + JNI)

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Volume 4 (Clients) nano-detail specification — deepens the **Android TunnelPlatform shim** sketched in the pass-1 client overview [03 §5.2] into an implementation-ready design of the single platform-specific component that lets HelixVPN's shared Rust `helix-core` drive a system VPN on Android. **SPEC ONLY:** it describes **what to build** (Kotlin/Rust signatures, the channel contract, the `VpnService` lifecycle state machine, the JNI/UniFFI bridge, the `tun fd` handoff, `protect()` loop-avoidance, the foreground service, memory budget, error taxonomy, edge cases, and §11.4.169 test points) — it does **not** write the shipping product.

**Boundary.** This shim is the *only* Android-specific code in the client stack [03 §0, §4]. It **consumes:** the FFI surface + `TunnelStatus` enum owned by the core (`helix-core/src/status.rs` [01-ORCH §4.1]; the Dart-facing FFI [03 §3]), and the `TunnelPlatform` channel contract [03 §4]. It **owns:** the Kotlin `VpnService` + foreground service, the `VpnService.Builder` → `ParcelFileDescriptor` `tun-fd` handoff, the JNI/UniFFI bridge that hands that `fd` to `helix-core` and registers the `protect()` upcall, and the `MethodChannel/EventChannel` marshalling. It does **not** own WG crypto, the transport ladder, the orchestrator loops, or the kill-switch/DNS state machine — those are core [01-ORCH], identical on every platform.

**Evidence base, cited inline by id.** [03 §N] = `final/03-client-core-and-ui.md` (pass-1 client overview); [01-ORCH §N] = `final/v02-data-plane/orchestrator-and-state.md` (the `TunnelStatus` / orchestrator the shim drives); [01-TT §N] = `final/v02-data-plane/transport-trait.md`; [04\_ARCH §N] = `04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-Architecture-Refined.md`; [04\_UI §N] = `04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-helix-ui-Flutter.md`; [research-ios\_android] = `v09-research/research-ios_android.md` (Apple DTS + Android `VpnService` primary-source research, all accessed 2026-06-25); [10-QA §N] = `final/10-testing-`

acceptance-and-qa.md; [06-WBS §0.4] = final/06-phase0-spike-wbs.md (the §11.4.169 code map); [SYN §N] = cross-document synthesis. Anything not grounded in that base is tagged UNVERIFIED per constitution §11.4.6 — never fabricated.

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## 0. Position, ownership, and invariants

The Android shim does **only three things** [03 §4]: (a) configure the OS tunnel (VpnService.Builder), (b) hand helix-core a packet fd + the protect() upcall, and (c) report lifecycle. Everything above it — ConnectButton, ExitPicker, settings, the TunnelStatus-driven UI — is shared Dart [03 §5, 04\_UI §6]. The shim is the *only untyped seam* (native ⇔ Dart) and is therefore covered by an on-device smoke test, never a mock-claiming-PASS (§11.4.27) [03 §4.1 O5].

### 0.1 Inherited invariants (the shim MUST keep)

| #   | Invariant | Source    | Android-specific consequence                                                            |
|-----|-----------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CI1 |           | [03 §0.1] | The Kotlin VpnService creates the tun + foreground service; helix-core (the same .so as |

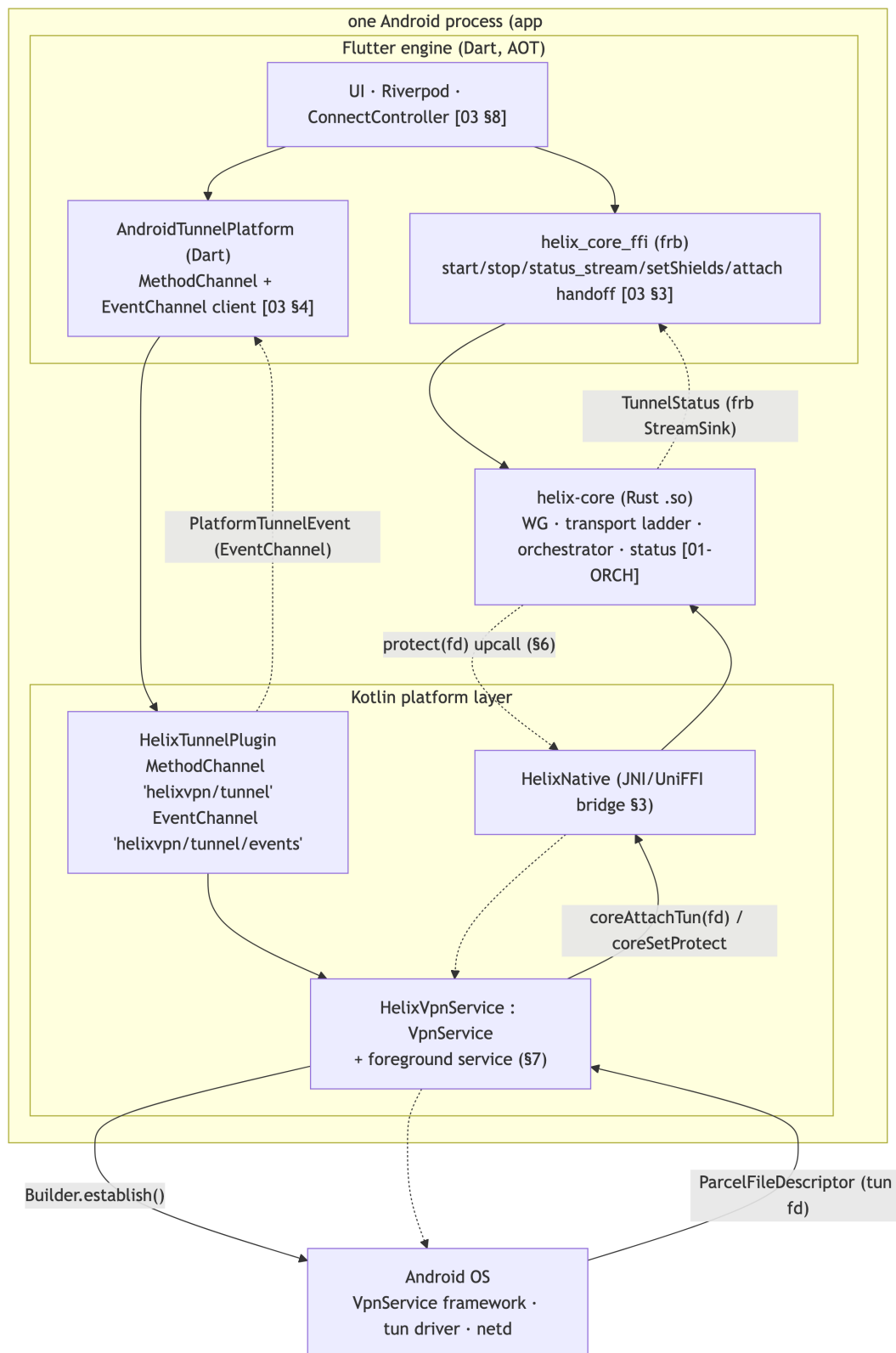
| #   | Invariant                                                                                                                                 | Source     | Android-specific consequence                                                                                                                                   |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|     | The shim does <b>not</b> own logic/status; it owns the OS tunnel lifecycle.                                                               |            | every platform) owns WG + transport + status.                                                                                                                  |
| O2  | The shim hands the core a packet fd/pump; it <b>never</b> does crypto/obfuscation.                                                        | [03 §4.1]  | coreAttachTun(fd); no WG/QUIC code in Kotlin.                                                                                                                  |
| CI2 | The UI is a pure function of the core's status stream; never paint "connected" on intent.                                                 | [03 §0.1]  | PlatformTunnelEvent.up ≠ TunnelStatus::Connected; Connected is emitted by the core <i>only</i> after the WG handshake reply [01-ORCH §5.4], never by the shim. |
| O1  | startTunnel is idempotent + permission-aware: a denied VPN consent emits permissionDenied (not error) and leaves <b>no</b> half-open tun. | [03 §4.1]  | §4, §9.1; cleanup on every exit path (§11.4.14).                                                                                                               |
| O3  | events() reports revoked when the OS kills the tunnel out-of-band.                                                                        | [03 §4.1]  | VpnService.onRevoke() → revoked (§4.4); never claim "connected".                                                                                               |
| O4  | stopTunnel restores a quiescent OS state on <b>every</b> exit path.                                                                       | [03 §4.1]  | coreDetachTun() → close fd → stopForeground → remove notification (§4.5, §11.4.14).                                                                            |
| I1  | The transport never sees plaintext; the shim never inspects payload.                                                                      | [01-TT I1] | The shim moves an opaque fd integer; it reads/writes <b>no</b> packet bytes (those flow inside the core).                                                      |

## 0.2 What this document does NOT own

- The TunnelStatus enum + its Down.reason vocabulary — frozen in helix-core/src/status.rs [01-ORCH §4.1, §4.4]; the shim is a transparent carrier of those events to Dart.
- The TransportConfig ladder, WG Tunn state machine, kill-switch/DNS state machine — core [01-ORCH §7, §8]; identical on every platform.
- The Dart-side TunnelPlatform *caller* / Riverpod wiring [03 §8]; this doc owns the Android *implementation* the Dart contract dispatches to.

# 1. Component & process map

HelixVPN runs the Flutter engine, the Rust `helix-core` .so, **and** the `VpnService` in **one Android process** (the app's default process). This is a load-bearing decision (§16 D-ANDROID-1): a single process lets `flutter_rust_bridge` (frb) stream `TunnelStatus` and serve `setShields/``setExit` **directly** from Dart to the in-process core [03 §3.2, §3.3], while the same in-process core holds the `tun` fd the `VpnService` produced — no cross-process IPC for status.



Two event paths leave the core (§8): **TunnelStatus** (core → frb → Dart, in-process, the truth about protection state), and **PlatformTunnelEvent** (Kotlin → EventChannel → Dart, the OS-tunnel lifecycle: up/down/permissionDenied/revoked/error). They are distinct and **MUST NOT** be conflated (CI2).

## 2. The TunnelPlatform contract — Android impl surface

The frozen Dart contract [03 §4] is one MethodChannel (helixvpn/tunnel) + one EventChannel (helixvpn/tunnel/events). The Android side implements the method handler and the event sink.

### 2.1 Dart TunnelPlatform (consumed — frozen [03 §4])

```
// helix_core_ffi/lib/tunnel_platform.dart (frozen contract – restated, not redefined)
abstract class TunnelPlatform {
  Future<void> startTunnel(TunnelConfig
    cfg); // OS permission + create TUN + link core + pump
  Future<void> stopTunnel(); // detach core, destroy TUN, release hold
  Stream<PlatformTunnelEvent> events(); // lifecycle only – up/down/permissionDenied/revoked/error
}

class TunnelConfig { // [03 §4]
  final String overlayIp; // e.g. 100.64.0.7 (overlay /32, IPAM-assigned)
  final List<String> routes; // AllowedIPs into the tunnel (e.g. "10.10.0.0/24" | "0.0.0.0/0")
  final List<String> dnsServers; // tunnel DNS (anti-leak)
  final List<String> splitExcludeApps; // Android per-app bypass (package names)
  final int mtu; // 1280 MASQUE default, 1420 plain WG [03 §4, 01-TT §4.8]
  final String sessionOrMapToken; // handed straight to helix_core start (logic, not OS)
  // ... ctor as in [03 §4]
}

enum PlatformTunnelEventKind { up, down, permissionDenied, revoked, error }
class PlatformTunnelEvent { final PlatformTunnelEventKind kind; final String? detail; /* §11.4.6 honest reason */ }
```

### 2.2 The Android MethodChannel verb map

| Dart call        | MethodChannel method              | Kotlin handler                           | Returns                                                                          |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| startTunnel(cfg) | "startTunnel"<br>(args = cfg map) | Plugin.onMethodCall<br>→ prepare check → | Future<void> (completes when the service is <i>started</i> , NOT when Connected) |

| Dart call     | MethodChannel method     | Kotlin handler                                                                                 | Returns                     |
|---------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| startTunnel() |                          | start HelixVpnService (§4.2)                                                                   |                             |
| stopTunnel()  | "stopTunnel"             | broadcast/<br>stopService →<br>Service.onDestroy<br>(§4.5)                                     | Future<void>                |
| events()      | EventChannel<br>onListen | Plugin registers an<br>EventSink; the service<br>posts<br>PlatformTunnelEvents<br>to it (§8.2) | Stream<PlatformTunnelEvent> |

startTunnel's Future resolving means "the OS VPN bring-up was *requested* and consent is granted" — **not** that the tunnel is up. Up-ness arrives later as a PlatformTunnelEvent.up (carrier/tun ready) and, authoritatively, as a core TunnelStatus::Connected (WG handshake done) (CI2, §8).

## 2.3 Arg marshalling (the one untyped seam, made honest)

TunnelConfig crosses Dart→Kotlin as a Map<String, Any?> over the MethodChannel. The Kotlin side parses it into a typed TunnelConfig data class; a missing/invalid field is a **hard** parse error → PlatformTunnelEvent.error with an honest detail (§11.4.6 — never a silent default), never a half-open tunnel (O1). A round-trip fixture test (§15 UT) asserts every field survives the Map encoding byte-for-byte.

```
// HelixTunnelConfig.kt
data class HelixTunnelConfig(
    val overlayIp: String,
    val routes: List<CidrRoute>,           // parsed "a.b.c.d/n" →
        (InetAddress, prefix)
    val dnsServers: List<String>,
    val splitExcludeApps: List<String>,
    val mtu: Int,
    val sessionOrMapToken: String,
) {
    companion object {
        fun from(args: Map<String, Any?>): HelixTunnelConfig = /*
            typed parse; throw on missing/invalid */
    }
}
data class CidrRoute(val address: String, val prefix: Int)
```

### 3. The JNI / UniFFI bridge to helix-core

The shared Rust core is loaded as a native .so via JNI [03 §5 matrix, SYN §5, research-ios\_android §3]. The **binding generator** is **UniFFI** for the typed Kotlin surface (decision D-CLIENT-3 [03 §14] — UniFFI gives typed Swift/Kotlin), with a **raw JNI export** reserved for the hot protect() upcall path where a per-socket UniFFI round-trip is undesirable (§6.3). frb generates the *Dart* surface [03 §3.2]; UniFFI generates the *native-shim* surface — two generators, one Rust source of truth [03 §3].

#### 3.1 The exported Rust FFI surface used by the Android shim

This is the subset of the frozen FFI surface [03 §3.1] the Kotlin shim drives, plus the **one Android-specific addition** the contract needs (set\_protect\_callback, §6). TunnelStatus is the 5-variant core enum [01-ORCH §4.1] — kept consistent below (§3.3).

```
// helix-ffi/src/api.rs - UniFFI + frb generate from this
// (restated subset; full surface in [03 §3.1])
// All bodies live in helix-core; this crate is the EXPORTED
// surface only [03 §0].

pub struct ClientConfig {                                // [03 §3.1]
    pub map_path_or_session: String,                      // =
    TunnelConfig.sessionOrMapToken
    pub transport: String,                                // "auto" | "plain" |
    "masque" | ...
    pub mode: CoreMode,                                   // Client (Android
    Access app) | Connector
}
#[derive(uniffi::Enum)] pub enum CoreMode { Client, Connector }

pub fn start(cfg: ClientConfig) -> Result<(), HelixError>; //
    logic bring-up (orchestrator start, [01-ORCH §2.1])
pub fn stop() -> Result<(), HelixError>;                 //
    graceful teardown

/// Shim handoff: the core NEVER opens the TUN; the VpnService
/// produces the fd and
/// hands it here. The core takes OWNERSHIP of the fd (closes it
/// on detach) – see §5.3.
pub fn attach_tun(fd: i32) -> Result<(), HelixError>;    //
    [03 §3.1]
pub fn detach_tun() -> Result<(), HelixError>;          //
    [03 §3.1]

/// Live status stream – maps to the orchestrator broadcast
/// channel [01-ORCH §4].
/// frb delivers this directly to Dart (in-process, §1); UniFFI
/// exposes it to Kotlin
/// too (the shim only needs it to drive PlatformTunnelEvent.up –
/// §8.3).
```

```

pub fn status_stream(sink: StreamSink<TunnelStatus>);           //
    [03 §3.1]

/// ANDROID-SPECIFIC ADDITION (§6). The core invokes this callback
to protect every
/// outbound transport socket against the VPN routing loop BEFORE
it connects.
/// Registered once at attach time. No-op / returns Ok on non-
Android targets.
pub fn set_protect_callback(cb: Box<dyn ProtectCallback>);    //
    NEW – Android contract extension
pub trait ProtectCallback: Send + Sync {
    /// Bind socket `fd` to the underlying physical network; true
    = protected.
    fn protect(&self, fd: i32) -> bool;
}

#[derive(uniffi::Error, Debug)] pub enum HelixError {
    Tun(String), KillSwitch(String), Dns(String),
    Internal(String) }

```

## 3.2 The UniFFI-generated Kotlin surface (primary path)

```

// generated by UniFFI from helix-ffi (do not hand-edit);
HelixNative wraps it for ergonomics.
object HelixNative {
    init { System.loadLibrary("helix_core") }           // load the .so
    once per process

    fun start(cfg: ClientConfig)                        // throws
        HelixException
    fun stop()
    fun attachTun(fd: Int)                             // hand the
        VpnService tun fd to the core (§5)
    fun detachTun()
    fun setProtectCallback(cb: ProtectCallback)         // §6
    fun subscribeStatus(sink: TunnelStatusSink)         // Kotlin-side
        status subscription (shim uses for .up only, §8.3)
}
interface ProtectCallback { fun protect(fd: Int):
    Boolean }      // implemented by HelixVpnService.protect
    (§6.2)

```

## 3.3 TunnelStatus — consistency with the core (frozen)

The shim is a **transparent carrier** of the core's TunnelStatus; it never defines its own. The canonical enum is helix-core/src/status.rs [01-ORCH §4.1]:

```

// helix-core/src/status.rs (frozen, mirrored across the FFI [01-
ORCH §4.1]) – restated for the binding
#[derive(Clone, Debug, PartialEq, Eq)]
pub enum TunnelStatus {

```

```

Connecting,                                     // dialling a
    rung (carrier handshake in flight)
Handshaking,                                   // carrier up;
    WG Noise IK handshake in flight
Connected { transport: String, rtt_ms: u32 }, // e.g.
    ("masque-h3", 23) – WG established
Reconnecting,                                 // a working
    tunnel dropped; re-dialling (ladder/backoff)
Down { reason: String },                      // terminal for
    this attempt; stable-prefix reason [01-ORCH §4.4]
}

```

**Consistency note (§11.4.6).** The pass-1 client overview presents an *extended* Dart mirror that adds `Disconnected`, a `path` field on `Connected`, and a `Danger{kind}` variant for the UI palette [03 §3.1 status-enum note]. Those are **FFI-presentation extensions** layered on top of this 5-variant core enum; this shim spec anchors on the **core 5-variant `TunnelStatus`** [01-ORCH §4.1] as the source of truth, exactly as the orchestrator emits it. The shim forwards whatever variant the core emits, unmodified — if/when the extended variants are ratified into the core enum, the shim needs **no change** (it is a transparent carrier). The Android shim emits its own **separate** `PlatformTunnelEvent` for OS-tunnel lifecycle (§8.2); it never synthesises a `TunnelStatus`.

### 3.4 Raw-JNI fallback (the `hot protect()` path)

For the per-socket `protect()` upcall (§6) the core may, instead of a `UniFFI` callback object, call a `#[no_mangle] extern "system" JNI` function or — as a perf option — the native `protectFromVpn` symbol (§6.3). The raw-JNI export shape:

```

// helix-ffi/src/jni_android.rs (cfg(target_os="android")) –
//    fallback / hot-path only
#[no_mangle]
pub extern "system" fn
    Java_dev_helixvpn_core_HelixNative_coreAttachTun(
        env: JNIEnv, _class: jclass, fd: jint) -> jint { /*
        attach_tun(fd) → 0 | errcode */ }

```

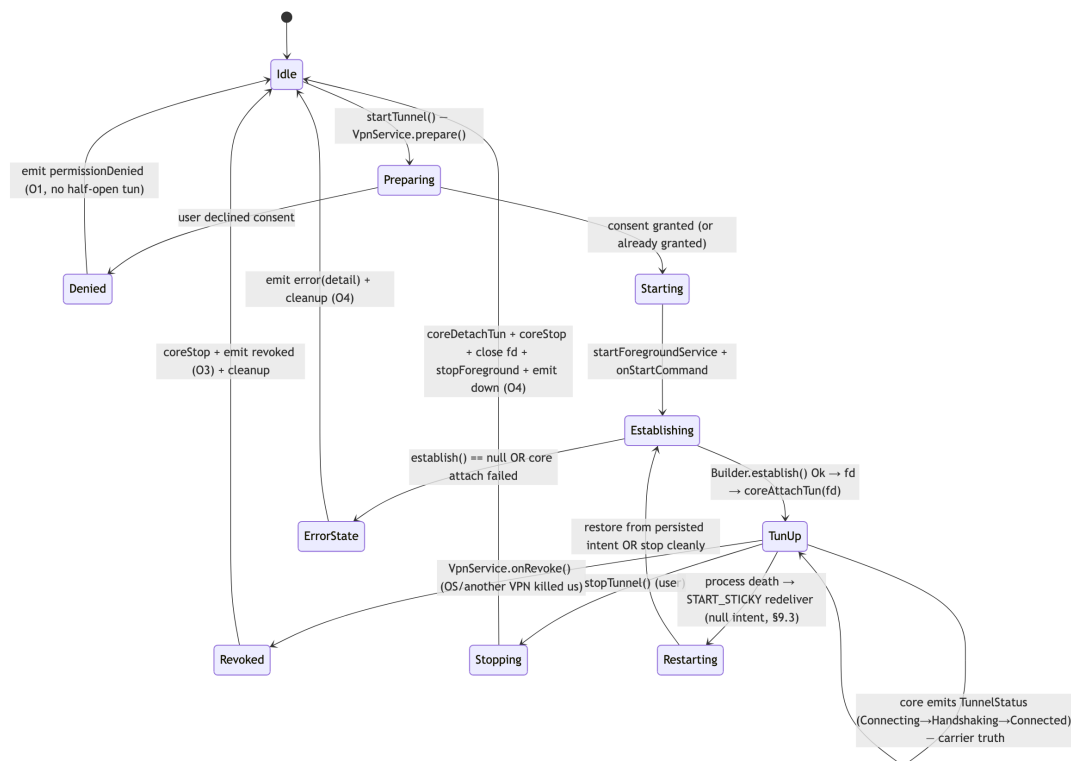
`UniFFI` is the **primary** typed surface; the raw JNI export exists only where the hot path or a `UniFFI` gap (UNVERIFIED: `UniFFI` callback-interface overhead per upcall — measure in BENCH, §15) justifies it.

---

## 4. VpnService lifecycle state machine

### 4.1 States (Kotlin-side, distinct from TunnelStatus)

The VpnService has its **own** lifecycle — the OS-tunnel layer — that the shim projects to PlatformTunnelEvent. It is *not* TunnelStatus: the tun can be Up (fd established, core attached) while TunnelStatus is still Handshaking (WG not yet established). The UI trusts TunnelStatus for protection state (CI2); the shim's lifecycle drives only the foreground service + the up/down/revoked events.



### 4.2 startTunnel → onStartCommand (the bring-up)

```
// HelixVpnService.kt
class HelixVpnService : VpnService(), HelixNative.ProtectCallback
{

    override fun onStartCommand(intent: Intent?, flags: Int,
        startId: Int): Int {
        // null intent => START_STICKY redelivery after process death
        // ($9.3) - restore or stop.
        val cfg = HelixTunnelConfig.from(intent?.bundleExtras() ?:
            return restoreOrStop())

        // 1. Foreground FIRST (must call startForeground within the
        // OS window, $7) - survive bg-kill.
        startForeground(NOTIF_ID,
            buildPersistentNotification()) // $7
```

```

// 2. Build + establish the TUN (§5). Null ⇒ another VPN
// active / invalid config (§12 E3).
val pfd: ParcelFileDescriptor = buildTun(cfg)
?: return failAndStop("establish() returned
null") // ErrorState

// 3. Register protect upcall BEFORE the core opens any
// transport socket (§6).
HelixNative.setProtectCallback(this)

// 4. Hand the fd to the core; take ownership via detachFd
// (§5.3). Then start the core logic.
val fd =
    pfd.detachFd() //
    native now owns close()
HelixNative.start(cfg.toClientConfig()) //
    orchestrator start [01-ORCH §2.1]
HelixNative.attachTun(fd) //
    core pumps fd ⇌ WG ⇌ transport

emitEvent(PlatformTunnelEventKind.up,
    null) // OS-tunnel up (NOT
    "connected", CI2)
return
    START_STICKY //
    §9.3 (with redelivery handling)
}
}

```

Ordering is load-bearing: **foreground first** (or the OS may kill a just-started background service before `establish()`), **establish before attach** (the core needs a live fd), **protect-callback before start** (the core may open a transport socket the instant it starts — it must be protectable, §6).

### 4.3 Handshaking → Connected is the core's call, not the shim's

The shim emits `PlatformTunnelEvent.up` once the *carrier* (fd + core attach) is ready. The user-visible "Connected" (green) is driven by the core's `TunnelStatus::Connected` over frb [01-ORCH §5.4, §3 §3.2] — emitted only after the **WG handshake reply** lands, never on tun-up. This split is the exact mechanism that prevents "UI says connected while the tunnel is actually down" (CI2) [03 §3.3].

### 4.4 onRevoke (O3)

```

override fun onRevoke()
{
    // OS or another VPN app took over, or
    // user revoked consent
    HelixNative.detachTun(); HelixNative.stop()
    emitEvent(PlatformTunnelEventKind.revoked, "os_revoked")
}

```

```
stopForeground(STOP_FOREGROUND_REMOVE); stopSelf()
}
```

onRevoke is the out-of-band kill path (O3). It also covers the control-plane revocation reflected as `device.revoked` (doc 02) when that propagates to a tunnel teardown — though a *cryptographic* WG revoke surfaces first as the core's `Down{reason:"auth-failed"}` over `TunnelStatus` [01-ORCH §5.4]; onRevoke is the *OS-level* VPN-permission revoke. Both end in a cleaned-up quiescent state (O4).

## 4.5 stopTunnel / onDestroy (O4)

```
override fun onDestroy() {                                // user stop OR system
    teardown                                                // core closes the
                                                            owned fd (§5.3)

    HelixNative.detachTun()                                // orchestrator
    graceful stop [01-ORCH §2.4]

    stopForeground(STOP_FOREGROUND_REMOVE) // remove the
    persistent notification (§7)
    emitEvent(PlatformTunnelEventKind.down, null)
    super.onDestroy()
}
```

Every exit path (`stopTunnel`, `onRevoke`, `onDestroy`, `ErrorState`, process-death) **MUST** leave: **no orphan fd** (core closed it), **no foreground notification**, **no leaked routes/DNS** (those were tun-scoped and die with the tun). A post-stop sanity assertion (§15 SEC/SC) FAILs the test if any orphan survives (§11.4.14).

---

# 5. VpnService.Builder → tun fd handoff

## 5.1 Building the interface

`VpnService.Builder` configures a Layer-3 interface: at least one address + routes/MTU before `establish()`, which returns a `ParcelFileDescriptor` for the TUN [research-ios\_android §3, 04\_UI §6 row]. The app reads/writes **raw IP packets** on that fd — there is no per-socket model [research-ios\_android §3].

```
private fun buildTun(cfg: HelixTunnelConfig):
    ParcelFileDescriptor? {
    val b = Builder()
    .setSession("HelixVPN") //
    label in the system VPN UI
```

```

        .addAddress(cfg.overlayIp, 32) //
            overlay /32 (IPAM-assigned)
        .setMtu(cfg.mtu) //
            1280 MASQUE / 1420 plain [01-TT §4.8]
        .setBlocking(false) //
            non-blocking fd (core pumps async)
    cfg.routes.forEach { b.addRoute(it.address, it.prefix) } //
        AllowedIPs (e.g. 0.0.0.0/0 full-tunnel)
    cfg.dnsServers.forEach { b.addDnsServer(it) } //
        tunnel DNS (anti-leak, §10.2)
    applySplitTunnel(b, cfg.splitExcludeApps) //
        §10.1 (per-app bypass)
    // Allow the app's OWN sockets to bypass the tun so the
    // transport can reach the gateway:
    // handled by protect() per-socket (§6), NOT by a bypass route –
    // keeps the kill-switch tight.
    return b.establish() //
        null ⇒ no VpnService permission / invalid
}

```

## 5.2 The fd is Layer-3 IP, owned by the core

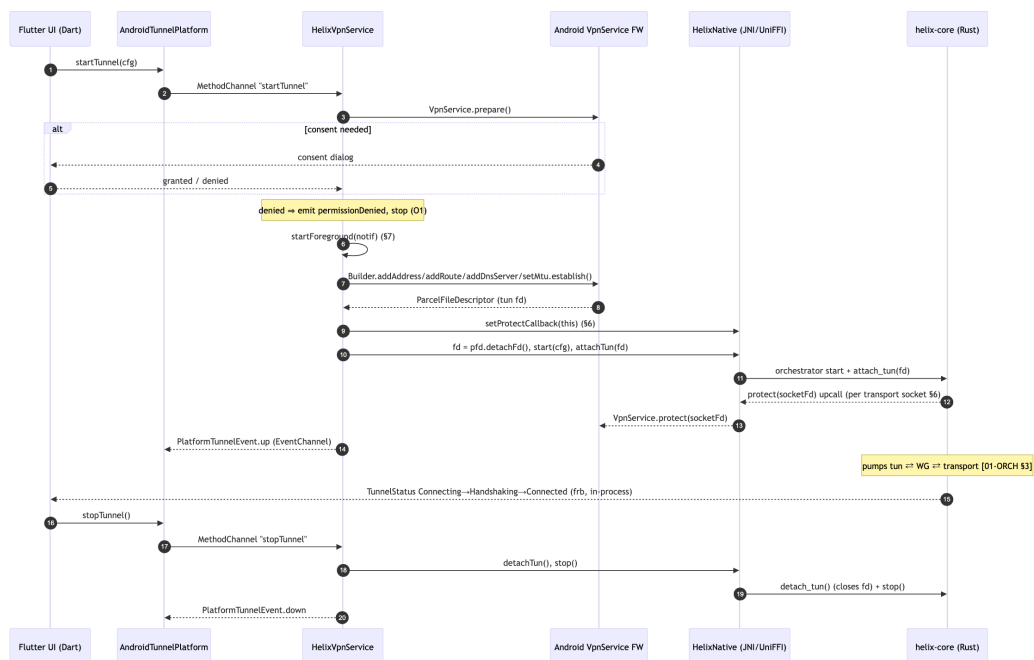
Once attached, helix-core does read(2)/write(2) of IP packets directly on the fd inside its loop A/B [01-ORCH §3.1, §3.2] — exactly the tun2socks-style native consumption pattern [research-ios\_android §3]. The Kotlin side never touches packet bytes (I1, O2).

## 5.3 fd ownership: detachFd() (recommended) vs getFd()

| Option                             | Ownership                                                                   | Who closes                                             | Trade-off                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>detachFd()</b><br>(recommended) | transfers the raw int fd to native; the ParcelFileDescriptor is invalidated | the <b>core</b> closes it in detach_tun()              | clean single-owner lifecycle; the core controls fd close exactly when it stops pumping [research-ios_android §3] |
| getFd()                            | Kotlin keeps the ParcelFileDescriptor alive                                 | Kotlin must keep pfd referenced and close() it on stop | risks a double-close or a leak if the service dies before Kotlin closes; needs careful                           |

| Option | Ownership | Who closes | Trade-off                |
|--------|-----------|------------|--------------------------|
|        |           |            | lifecycle<br>bookkeeping |

**Decision (D-ANDROID-2, §16):** use `detachFd()` → the core owns and closes the fd via `detach_tun()`. The Kotlin side keeps **no** `ParcelFileDescriptor` reference after `detachFd()` (it is invalidated). Edge: if the core process dies, the fd is reclaimed at process death — acceptable, no cross-process leak.



## 6. protect() — the loopback-avoidance contract

### 6.1 Why it is mandatory

`VpnService.protect(socket)` binds a socket to the **underlying physical network**, so the tunnel's own outbound transport packets (to the gateway) do **not** get routed back into the tun — which would infinite-loop. It **MUST** be called **before** the socket connects/sends, for **every** outbound transport socket the core opens [research-ios\_android §3]. Without it the tunnel cannot carry its own carrier traffic. This is the single Android-specific obligation that forces a **core** → **shim upcall** (the core opens the socket inside `helix-transport::dial()` [01-TT §6], so only the core knows the fd; only the shim can `protect()` it).

## 6.2 The upcall (primary path: VpnService.protect)

The core invokes the registered ProtectCallback synchronously, before connect(), for each transport socket:

```
// HelixVpnService implements HelixNative.ProtectCallback
override fun protect(fd: Int): Boolean = protect(fd) //
    VpnService.protect(int) - true on success

// inside helix-transport dial(), cfg(target_os="android"):
    protect every socket before connect
let sock = socket2::Socket::new(domain, ty, proto)?;
if !PROTECT.get().map_or(false, |cb|
    cb.protect(sock.as_raw_fd())) {
    return Err(TransportError::Io(io::Error::other("protect()
        failed"))); // never connect an unprotected socket
}
sock.connect(&peer.into())?; // [01-TT §6.1]
```

A failed protect() is a **hard** dial error (TransportError::Io → ladder/backoff [01-TT §7, 01-ORCH §7]) — the core MUST NOT connect an unprotected socket (it would leak onto the underlay and loop). This is verified by the §15 SEC test (a captured pcap shows transport packets egress the physical iface, not the tun).

## 6.3 Hot-path option: native protectFromVpn (perf)

VpnService.protect() ultimately calls the C function protectFromVpn (NetdClient.h); a native core can bind that symbol and protect sockets entirely in native space, avoiding a JNI/UniFFI upcall on the hot connect path [research-ios\_android §3]. **Decision (D-ANDROID-3, §16):** use the ProtectCallback upcall as the **safe default** (protect is not on the per-packet hot path — it fires once per socket / per dial, which is rare); adopt native protectFromVpn only if BENCH (§15) shows the upcall cost matters. UNVERIFIED: protectFromVpn's symbol stability across Android versions / OEM images — it is **not** a public NDK symbol; binding it is a documented community pattern, not a guaranteed-stable ABI [research-ios\_android §3]. Treat as an optimization behind a measured gate, never the default (§11.4.6).

## 6.4 Re-protect on roam

When the device's primary network changes (Wi-Fi→cellular), the previously-protected socket's underlying network may vanish → the carrier dies → the core re-dials [01-ORCH §7.5] → a **new** transport socket is opened → protect() is invoked again on the **new** network. The shim feeds the roam signal to the core via a ConnectivityManager.NetworkCallback → RoamDetected{new\_local} [01-ORCH §7.5, §9]; the core's < 3 s roam

recovery [01-ORCH §7.1] then re-establishes a freshly protected socket. No special shim logic beyond delivering the roam event and answering the protect upcall.

---

## 7. Foreground service — surviving background-kill

A VPN tunnel must keep running when the app is backgrounded; Android only keeps a service alive in the background if it is a **foreground service** with a persistent notification [research-ios\_android §3 implies via VpnService foreground practice; 03 §5.2 startForeground].

```
private fun buildPersistentNotification(): Notification {  
    // Notification channel created once at app start (API 26+).  
    return NotificationCompat.Builder(this, CHANNEL_ID)  
        .setSmallIcon(R.drawable.ic_helix_shield)  
        .setContentTitle("HelixVPN")  
        .setContentText("Protected") // updated from  
        TunnelStatus over a status subscription (§8.3)  
        .setOngoing(true)  
        .setCategory(NotificationCompat.CATEGORY_SERVICE)  
        .build()  
}  
// onStartCommand: startForeground(NOTIF_ID,  
    buildPersistentNotification() [, foregroundServiceType])
```

| Concern                 | Requirement                                                                                  | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Foreground window       | startForeground() MUST be called promptly inside onStartCommand (before establish() in §4.2) | else the OS may kill the just-started service                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Notification channel    | created once (API 26+) before first startForeground                                          | POST_NOTIFICATIONS runtime permission on API 33+                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Foreground service type | a foregroundServiceType MUST be declared (manifest) + passed on API 34+                      | UNVERIFIED: the exact constant for a VPN foreground service on API 34+ — verify against the latest Android docs (§11.4.99) before coding; declare the matching FOREGROUND_SERVICE_* permission. Do not hardcode a guessed type. |

Restart

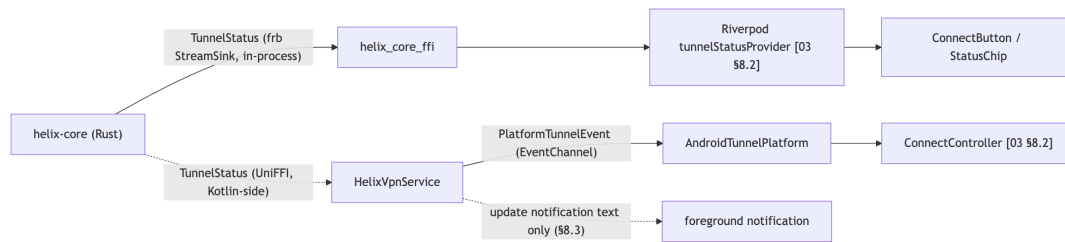
| Concern           | Requirement                                                                 | Note                                                                                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                   | START_STICKY so the OS recreates the service after a low-memory kill (§9.3) | with null-intent redelivery handling                                                         |
| Notification text | reflects TunnelStatus (Connecting/Connected/Reconnecting)                   | the shim keeps a lightweight Kotlin-side status subscription only to update this text (§8.3) |

**Android memory posture (contrast iOS).** Android VpnService runs as a normal foreground service — there is **no** iOS-NE-style hard ~15/50 MiB jetsam cap; the standard Android per-app memory / lowmemorykiller applies, which is far more generous, and a foreground service is high-priority [research-ios\_android §3]. The severe memory constraint is **iOS-only**; on Android the foreground-service priority is the survival mechanism, not a tight RSS budget (§11). The shim still bounds buffer pools in the core (size receive buffers to MTU+headroom [research-ios\_android §3, §4]) because the **same lean Rust core** ships on both.

## 8. Status & event flow (the two channels)

### 8.1 The two distinct streams

| Stream                     | Producer<br>→<br>consumer | Transport                                     | Carries                                                                                      | Truth<br>about                                                      |
|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>TunnelStatus</b>        | helix-core → Dart         | frb StreamSink, in-process [03 §3.2]          | Connecting/Handshaking/ Connected{transport, rtt}/ Reconnecting/ Down{reason} [01-ORCH §4.1] | <b>protection state</b> (WC tunnel) — the UI paints from this (CI2) |
| <b>PlatformTunnelEvent</b> | Kotlin shim → Dart        | EventChannel helixvpn/ tunnel/ events [03 §4] | up/down/ permissionDenied/ revoked/error                                                     | <b>OS-tunnel lifecycle</b> (consent, fd, foreground service)        |



## 8.2 PlatformTunnelEvent emission rules

The shim emits exactly one event per OS-tunnel transition (§4): up on `establish()+attach` success; down on graceful stop; `permissionDenied` on declined consent; `revoked` on `onRevoke`; `error{detail}` on `establish()==null` / attach failure / config-parse failure. `detail` is an **honest** string (§11.4.6 — never "likely"/"maybe"). Events post to the registered `EventSink` on the platform thread; if no listener is attached yet, the latest lifecycle event is buffered (UNVERIFIED: buffer depth = 1 latest, sufficient because the UI re-reads latest on listen — calibrate in §15 UT).

## 8.3 Why the shim also subscribes to TunnelStatus (notification text)

The shim keeps a **lightweight** Kotlin-side `TunnelStatus` subscription (`HelixNative.subscribeStatus`) for **one** purpose: updating the persistent notification text (`Connecting.../Protected · masque-h3 · 23 ms/Reconnecting...`). This is presentation only; the shim never *re-derives* protection state nor feeds it back to the UI (the UI already has the authoritative frb stream, CI2). A `RecvError::Lagged` on this subscription is treated as "re-read latest", never an error [01-ORCH §4.6].

# 9. Permission, always-on, and boot

## 9.1 Permission flow (VpnService.prepare)

`VpnService.prepare(context)` returns an `Intent` if the user has not yet consented to this app acting as a VPN (must be launched via `startActivityForResult`), or `null` if already consented. Declined consent → `PlatformTunnelEvent.permissionDenied`, **no** service start, no half-open tun (O1).

```

fun startTunnel(cfg): Future {
    val prep = VpnService.prepare(context)           // null =
                                                    already granted
    if (prep != null) { launchConsent(prepare) /* on result:
                                                    granted→continue | denied→permissionDenied */ }
}

```

```
    else startService(cfg)
}
```

## 9.2 Always-on VPN & lockdown (the Android kill-switch)

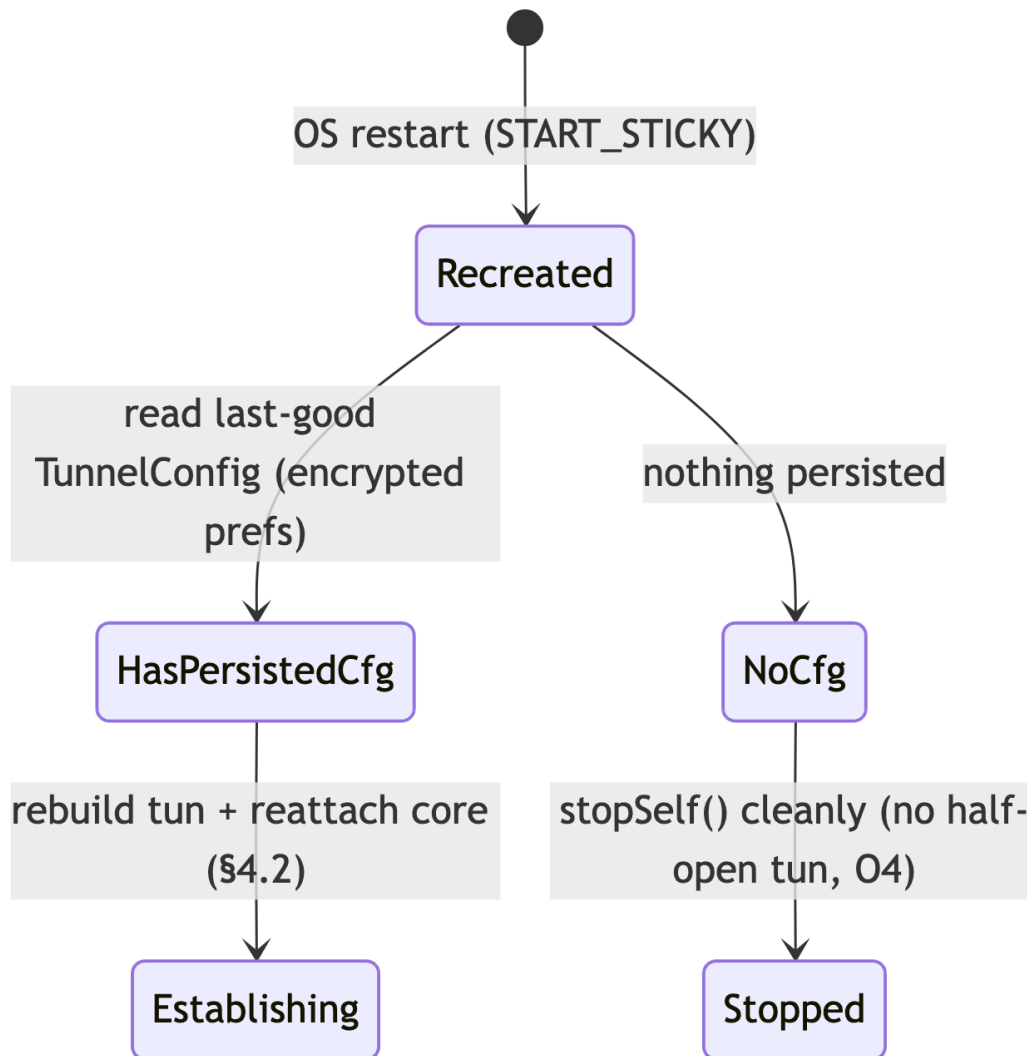
Android's system **Always-on VPN + Block connections without VPN (lockdown)** setting is the OS-level kill-switch on Android [04\_ARCH §5.6 "kill-switch+DNS driven by core state machine"; the OS lockdown is the platform mechanism]. When lockdown is on, the OS starts HelixVpnService via an OS-issued intent (no UI) and drops all non-VPN traffic. The shim MUST therefore:

- handle a service start with **no** UI in the foreground (start foreground + build the tun from a **persisted** last-good TunnelConfig, §9.3);
- never assume the Flutter UI is alive when onStartCommand fires.

The core's own fail-closed kill-switch posture [01-ORCH §8] composes with the OS lockdown: the core drops on Reconnecting/Down regardless, and Android lockdown additionally blocks at the OS routing layer. The two are complementary, not redundant.

## 9.3 Process death & START\_STICKY

If the OS kills the service under memory pressure, START\_STICKY recreates it and re-delivers onStartCommand with a **null** intent. The shim must then:



The last-good TunnelConfig is persisted (the sessionOrMapToken is a secret → stored in EncryptedSharedPreferences / Keystore-backed store, never plaintext, §11.4.10) so always-on/lockdown and post-kill restarts can re-establish without the UI. UNVERIFIED: whether to auto-reconnect on every redelivery vs only under lockdown — surface as D-ANDROID-4 (§16); default = reconnect only if the user's last intent was "connected" (mirrors [03 §8.4] intent honesty).

---

## 10. Split-tunnel, DNS, routes, MTU

### 10.1 Per-app split tunnel

VpnService.Builder supports **either** `addDisallowedApplication(pkg)` (exclude-list: everything tunnels except these) **or** `addAllowedApplication(pkg)` (include-list: only these tunnel) — the two modes are **mutually exclusive** (you cannot mix them on one Builder).

```
private fun applySplitTunnel(b: Builder, exclude: List<String>) {
    // HelixVPN MVP uses the exclude model (cfg.splitExcludeApps)
    [03 §4 TunnelConfig.splitExcludeApps].
    exclude.forEach { pkg -> runCatching {
        b.addDisallowedApplication(pkg) } } // ignore unknown pkg
    (honest skip)
}
```

A package that is not installed throws `NameNotFoundException`; the shim skips it with an honest log, never aborts the whole tunnel (§11.4.6 — but the skip is *recorded*, not silent). Include-mode (`addAllowedApplication`) is a Phase-2 config knob (D-ANDROID-5, §16).

## 10.2 DNS leak protection

Tunnel DNS is set via `addDnsServer(it)` for each `cfg.dnsServers`. Because all routes (including `0.0.0.0/0` in full-tunnel mode) go into the tun and no bypass route is added, off-tunnel `:53` cannot egress — this is the Android realisation of the core's "force tunnel DNS; block plaintext `:53` off-tunnel" guarantee [04\_ARCH §5.6, 01-ORCH §8.3]. Split-tunnel excluded apps deliberately bypass (per user config); that is an explicit user choice, surfaced honestly in the UI, not a leak.

## 10.3 Routes & MTU

- Routes = `cfg.routes` (AllowedIPs): `0.0.0.0/0` (+ `::/0` for v6) for full-tunnel privacy-exit mode; specific overlay CIDRs (e.g. `10.10.0.0/24`) for joined-network-only mode [SYN §1].
- MTU = `cfg.mtu`: 1280 over MASQUE, 1420 plain WG [01-TT §4.8] — the value the core computed from `effective_mtu()` of the active transport and pushed into the `TunnelConfig` [01-ORCH §6.6]. The shim does not invent the MTU.

# 11. Memory & performance budget

| Budget                | Android target                                     | Basis                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core steady-state RSS | low-tens MB; <b>no hard jetsam cap</b> like iOS NE | Android <code>VpnService</code> is a normal foreground service; <code>lowmemorykiller</code> is generous [research-ios_android §3] |
| Buffer pools          | bounded; receive buffer sized to MTU+headroom      | same lean Rust core as iOS; bound pools to avoid spike-kills [research-ios_android §3, §4]                                         |
|                       |                                                    | §7                                                                                                                                 |

| Budget              | Android target                                          | Basis                                              |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Foreground priority | high (foreground service) protects against bg-kill      |                                                    |
| App install size    | shares the --split-per-abi lean Rust staticlib          | [03 §10]                                           |
| Packet path         | core does read/write on the fd in its own tokio threads | no Kotlin on the per-packet path (§5.2)            |
| protect() cost      | once per transport socket (rare), not per packet        | §6.3 (native protectFromVpn only if BENCH demands) |

The binding memory constraint of the program is **iOS NE**, not Android [research-ios\_android §3, §4; CI4 03 §0.1]. On Android the shim's job is survival (foreground service) and correctness (protect, fd lifecycle), not a tight RSS ceiling. The Android MEM test (§15) is a **regression guard** (dumpsys meminfo, no leak over a soak), not a make-or-break gate (the make-or-break G3 is iOS-only [03 §5.1]).

## 12. Error taxonomy & edge cases

| #  | Condition                                                       | Required behaviour                      | Event / state                          | Source                          |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| E1 | VPN consent declined                                            | no service start; no half-open tun (O1) | permissionDenied → Idle                | §9.1                            |
| E2 | Config map missing/invalid field                                | hard parse error; no tun                | error{detail} → Idle                   | §2.3                            |
| E3 | establish() returns null (another VPN active / invalid Builder) | cleanup; no orphan fd                   | error{"establish_null"} → Idle         | §5.1, [research-ios_android §3] |
| E4 | protect() fails on a transport socket                           | core does NOT connect; ladder/backoff   | core TransportError::Io → Reconnecting | §6.2                            |
| E5 |                                                                 | coreStop; quiescent                     | revoked → Idle                         | §4.4                            |

| #   | Condition                                       | Required behaviour                                                                       | Event / state                     | Source                             |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
|     | onRevoke (OS / another VPN / user revoke)       | restore (O3,O4)                                                                          |                                   |                                    |
| E6  | Roam (Wi-Fi→cellular) while connected           | feed<br>RoamDetected;<br>core re-dials + re-protects;<br>< 3 s recovery                  | core<br>Reconnecting→Connected    | §6.4, [01-ORCH §7.5]               |
| E7  | Process death (lowmemorykiller) while connected | START_STICKY<br>redeliver;<br>restore from persisted cfg<br>OR stop cleanly              | Restarting → Establishing/Stopped | §9.3                               |
| E8  | Always-on/ lockdown start with no UI            | start<br>foreground + build tun from persisted cfg<br>without the Flutter engine         | Establishing (headless)           | §9.2                               |
| E9  | WG cryptographic revoke (device.revoked)        | core emits<br>Down{auth-failed} over TunnelStatus;<br>kill-switch stays closed           | TunnelStatus::Down + shim down    | [01-ORCH §5.4, §8.5]               |
| E10 | stopTunnel while mid-handshake                  | detach+stop cleanly; close fd; no orphan                                                 | down → Idle                       | §4.5                               |
| E11 | Unknown split-exclude package                   | skip with honest record; tunnel proceeds                                                 | (logged)                          | §10.1                              |
| E12 | Notification permission denied (API 33+)        | foreground still required; surface the limitation honestly; tunnel proceeds if OS allows | (logged)                          | §7 (UNVERIFIED: per-OEM behaviour) |

Error-classification rule (§11.4.6): the shim never labels a failure "transient/flaky"; `error.detail` is a concrete observed cause or an explicit UNKNOWN:/PENDING\_FORENSICS: marker with a tracked follow-up.

---

## 13. Threading & cancel model

- `onStartCommand` runs on the **main thread**; `establish()` is cheap; the per-packet pump runs inside the **core's own tokio threads** after `attach_tun` (the shim never blocks the main thread with packet I/O) [01-ORCH §3].
  - The `frb TunnelStatus` stream is delivered off the platform thread by `frb` [03 §3.2]; the Kotlin-side notification subscription (§8.3) hops to the main thread only to update the notification.
  - `protect()` upcalls are synchronous and brief (one `protect(int)` syscall); they occur on whatever core thread opened the socket — the `ProtectCallback impl` MUST be thread-safe and reentrancy-free (it only calls `VpnService.protect`, which is thread-safe).
  - Cancellation: `stopTunnel/onDestroy/onRevoke` call `detach_tun()` + `stop()`, which cancel the core's `CancellationToken` and join its loops within `shutdown_grace` (2 s default) [01-ORCH §2.4]; the fd is closed by the core on detach (§5.3). No core thread outlives the service.
- 

## 14. Manifest & build requirements

```
<!-- AndroidManifest.xml (essentials) -->
<uses-permission
    android:name="android.permission.FOREGROUND_SERVICE"/>
<!-- API 34+: declare the matching FOREGROUND_SERVICE_<type>
    permission (UNVERIFIED exact type, §7) -->
<uses-permission
    android:name="android.permission.POST_NOTIFICATIONS"/>
<!-- API 33+ -->

<service
    android:name=".HelixVpnService"
    android:permission="android.permission.BIND_VPN_SERVICE"
    android:exported="false">
    <!-- android:foregroundServiceType="..." on API 34+
        (UNVERIFIED exact value, §7) -->
    <intent-filter><action android:name="android.net.VpnService"/>
    </intent-filter>
</service>
```

- The `.so` is the shared lean Rust `helix-core staticlib`→`cdylib` for Android ABIs (arm64-v8a, armeabi-v7a, x86\_64), `--split-per-abi` to keep install

size lean [03 §10]; same `opt-level="z"/"s"` + LTO + `panic=abort` + strip profile as iOS for code-size/footprint parity [research-ios\_android §2].

- UniFFI Kotlin bindings + frb Dart bindings are **generated and drift-checked** in the local melos build (no active CI per §11.4.156 [SYN §9]); a binding drift vs the Rust `helix-ffi` source is a build-blocking finding [03 §11].

---

## 15. Test points (§11.4.169)

§11.4.169 (a LIVE constitution anchor) mandates that every workable item declare its required test types from the closed vocabulary [06-WBS §0.4, 10-QA §2]; the only permitted absence of a warranted type is an honest §11.4.3 SKIP-with-reason, never a silent gap. The shim is the **only untyped seam**, so its evidence bar is the on-device smoke (O5). Four-layer enforcement per §11.4.4(b) applies to every closure.

| Code | Type                                                               | Android-shim test point                                                                                                                                                                                        | Evidence (§11.4.5/.69/.107)             |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| UT   | unit                                                               | <code>HelixTunnelConfig.from(map)</code> round-trip (every field survives, §2.3); <code>PlatformTunnelEvent</code> mapping; split-tunnel mode-exclusivity guard; detail honesty (no forbidden vocab)           | gradle test / Robolectric logs          |
| INT  | integration (real system, infra via containers submodule §11.4.76) | the Kotlin shim + real <code>helix-core</code> .so on an emulator: <code>startTunnel</code> → <code>establish()</code> → <code>attachTun</code> → core reaches a real edge booted on-demand                    | logcat + netns/ edge round-trip         |
| E2E  | end-to-end                                                         | on-device: real Access flavor → <code>connect</code> → <code>curl/app</code> traffic reaches an authorized LAN host through the tun; plain-UDP <b>blocked</b> path escalates to MASQUE [01-ORCH §7]            | window-scoped MP4 (§11.4.159) + capture |
| FA   | full-automation (§11.4.25/.52/.98, deterministic §11.4.50)         | scripted (uiautomator/adb) <code>connect</code> → <code>status</code> → <code>disconnect</code> , <b>N=3 identical</b> <code>PlatformTunnelEvent</code> + <code>TunnelStatus</code> traces, zero human-in-loop | 3× identical trace artifacts            |
| SEC  |                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                         |

| Code           | Type                                     | Android-shim test point                                                                                                                                                                                        | Evidence (§11.4.5/.69/.107)            |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
|                | security (§11.4.10 + security submodule) | (a) pcap proves transport sockets egress the <b>physical</b> iface (protect works, §6) not the tun; (b) no off-tunnel :53 leak (§10.2); (c) sessionOrMapToken never in logs / plaintext prefs (§9.3, §11.4.10) | pcap + secret-leak grep-empty          |
| STRESS         | stress (§11.4.85)                        | sustained connect/disconnect churn ( $\geq 100$ cycles); fd-leak census (/proc/<pid>/fd count stable); bounded RSS                                                                                             | fd-count + RSS CSV                     |
| CHAOS          | chaos (§11.4.85)                         | iface flap (toggle Wi-Fi/cellular) mid-transfer $\rightarrow < 3$ s recovery (§6.4, E6); process-kill (am kill) $\rightarrow$ START_STICKY restore (E7); onRevoke mid-transfer (E5)                            | recovery trace + logcat                |
| CONC           | concurrency / atomicity                  | concurrent startTunnel/stopTunnel calls (idempotency, O1); protect() upcalls from multiple core threads thread-safe                                                                                            | harness log                            |
| RACE           | race / deadlock                          | no deadlock between onDestroy (detach) and an in-flight protect() upcall; fd close-vs-use ordering                                                                                                             | stress harness + tsan-style assertions |
| MEM            | memory                                   | regression guard: dumpsys meminfo RSS stable over a soak; no fd/handle leak; <b>not</b> a make-or-break (iOS owns G3)                                                                                          | dumpsys meminfo series                 |
| BENCH/<br>PERF | benchmarking / performance               | through-tunnel throughput on device; protect() upcall cost (decides D-ANDROID-3 §6.3); attach $\rightarrow$ Connected latency                                                                                  | throughput/latency CSV                 |
| UI/UX          | UI / UX                                  | the shared Flutter ConnectButton/StatusChip driven by real TunnelStatus on device; consent-dialog flow                                                                                                         | golden + flow MP4                      |
| REC            | recorded-evidence                        | window-scoped MP4 (§11.4.154/.155) of the real connect journey, StatusChip                                                                                                                                     | helixvpng---<br>android-               |

| Code            | Type                                 | Android-shim test point                                                                              | Evidence (§11.4.5/.69/.107)  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| CHAL/<br>HQA    | Challenge /<br>HelixQA<br>(§11.4.27) | reading e.g. masque-h3 · 23<br>ms confirmed by vision/OCR<br>(§11.4.163)                             | connect----<run-<br>id>.mp4  |
|                 |                                      | a challenges/helix_qa bank<br>entry scoring PASS only on the<br>captured on-device evidence<br>above | bank result.json             |
| DDOS /<br>SCALE | —                                    | NOT_APPLICABLE: single-<br>node-selfhost (§11.4.3<br>topology-SKIP) — re-arm<br>Phase 2              | tracked SKIP-<br>with-reason |

**Anti-bluff (§11.4.107/.158).** A green Kotlin unit test is not proof the user is protected. The authoritative evidence is the **on-device** E2E+SEC+REC bundle: a window-scoped MP4 of the real connect journey on a real device, the pcap proving protect() keeps the carrier off the tun, and the curl-reaches-LAN capture — never a mock-claiming-PASS (O5, §11.4.27).

## 16. Open decisions & cross-doc seams

Per §11.4.6/§11.4.66 — surfaced with a recommendation, never silently resolved.

| #               | Decision            | Option A                                                                 | Option B                         | Re                                                            |
|-----------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| D-<br>ANDROID-1 | Process<br>model    | single process (core .so +<br>VpnService + Flutter share<br>one process) | :vpn separate service<br>process | A -<br>frb<br>an<br>se<br>Da<br>(§1<br>for<br>AI<br>co<br>frb |
| D-<br>ANDROID-2 | tun fd<br>ownership | detachFd() → core owns +<br>closes (§5.3)                                | getFd() → Kotlin owns            | A -<br>lif<br>ex<br>[re<br>§3                                 |

| #               | Decision                                            | Option A                                           | Option B                                                      | Re                                                    |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| D-<br>ANDROID-3 | protect()<br>mechanism                              | VpnService.protect upcall<br>(typed, safe)         | native protectFromVpn<br>(perf)                               | A c<br>BE<br>ma<br>pr<br>sta<br>(\$6                  |
| D-<br>ANDROID-4 | Auto-<br>reconnect on<br>START_STICKY<br>redelivery | always reconnect                                   | reconnect only if last<br>intent = connected (or<br>lockdown) | B -<br>int<br>sur<br>(\$9                             |
| D-<br>ANDROID-5 | Split-tunnel<br>model                               | exclude-list<br>(addDisallowedApplication,<br>MVP) | include-list<br>(addAllowedApplication,<br>Phase 2)           | A f<br>(ct<br>B a<br>(\$1<br>ex                       |
| D-<br>ANDROID-6 | API-34+<br>foreground-<br>service type              | (must be resolved before<br>coding)                | —                                                             | Ve<br>ou<br>pe<br>for<br>ag<br>An<br>(\$<br>he<br>a g |

#### Cross-doc seams this shim fixes / consumes:

| Seam                                                                                                            | Direction                                        | Counterpart                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TunnelStatus (5-variant)                                                                                        | consumed,<br>transparently<br>forwarded          | helix-core/<br>src/status.rs<br>[01-ORCH §4.1]<br>[03 §3.1]; the<br>protect-<br>callback is the<br>Android-<br>specific<br>extension<br>(§3.1, §6) |
| FFI surface (start/stop/<br>attach_tun/detach_tun/<br>status_stream) + the <b>new</b><br>set_protect_callback   | consumed + the protect<br>addition proposed here |                                                                                                                                                    |
| TunnelPlatform channel<br>contract (startTunnel/<br>stopTunnel/events,<br>TunnelConfig,<br>PlatformTunnelEvent) | implemented                                      | [03 §4]                                                                                                                                            |

| Seam                                | Direction                                                      | Counterpart                                     |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| RoamDetected{new_local}             | produced by the shim's ConnectivityManager callback            | consumed by the orchestrator [01-ORCH §7.5, §9] |
| device.revoked → OS-tunnel teardown | the OS-level onRevoke complements the core's Down{auth-failed} | doc 02 control plane + [01-ORCH §5.4]           |

## Sources verified

- final/03-client-core-and-ui.md [03] — §0.1 (client invariants CI1–CI6), §3 (FFI surface, ClientConfig, attach\_tun/detach\_tun, the Dart TunnelStatus mirror + status-enum note), §4 (the TunnelPlatform contract, TunnelConfig, PlatformTunnelEvent, obligations O1–O5), §5.2 (the Android VpnService+JNI Kotlin sketch this doc deepens), §8 (Riverpod wiring), §10 (budgets), §11 (build/CI), §14 (D-CLIENT-3 binding generator).
- final/v02-data-plane/orchestrator-and-state.md [01-ORCH] — §4.1 (the frozen 5-variant TunnelStatus), §4.4 (Down. reason vocabulary), §4.6 (receiver contract / Lagged), §5.4 (Connected only after WG handshake; auth-failed), §7.5 (RoamDetected, < 3 s roam), §8 (kill-switch/DNS state machine), §2.4 (shutdown).
- final/v02-data-plane/transport-trait.md [01-TT] — §4.8 (effective\_mtu per carrier → MTU 1280/1420), §6 (dial opens the socket the shim must protect), §7 (error taxonomy → ladder).
- v09-research/research-ios\_android.md [research-ios\_android] (all sources accessed 2026-06-25) — §3 (Android VpnService.Builder addAddress/addRoute/addDnsServer/setMtu/establish() → ParcelFileDescriptor; Layer-3 fd I/O; detachFd() vs getFd() ownership; protect() mandatory before connect; native protectFromVpn/NetdClient; Android has no iOS-NE-style jetsam cap), §4 (cross-platform synthesis; bound buffers to MTU+headroom; iOS is the binding constraint), §2 (size-first Rust profile shared with Android).
- 04\_VPN\_CLD/HelixVPN-Architecture-Refined.md [04\_ARCH] — §5.3 shim matrix (Android = VpnService+JNI, Kotlin, ParcelFileDescriptor fd ⇔ core), §5.6 (kill-switch/DNS driven by core state machine; tunnel DNS forces, blocks off-tunnel :53).
- 04\_VPN\_CLD/HelixVPN-helix-ui-Flutter.md [04\_UI] — §6 shim row (Android core via JNI; foreground service), build/CI matrix.

- `final/06-phase0-spike-wbs.md` [06-WBS §0.4] + `final/10-testing-acceptance-and-qa.md` [10-QA §2] — the §11.4.169 closed test-type code map.
- `v09-research/_SYNTHESIS.md` [SYN] — §5 (client shim architecture), §9 (constitution bindings: §11.4.156 no-CI, §11.4.151/.155 prefixes, §11.4.10).

*Constitution: §11.4.6 (no-guessing — every UNVERIFIED marked, none fabricated), §11.4.66 (decisions = options + recommendation), §11.4.10 (secret token handling), §11.4.14 (cleanup on every exit path), §11.4.99 (verify API-34 foreground type against latest docs), §11.4.107/.158/.159 (captured on-device window-scoped evidence), §11.4.169 (per-item test-type coverage), §11.4.156 (no active CI).*

*End of Volume 4 nano-detail specification — Android shim (VpnService + JNI). Pairs with [03 §5.2] (the overview this deepens), [01-ORCH §4] (TunnelStatus), and the sibling per-platform shim specs (apple/windows/linux/harmonyos/aurora). Surfaced decisions D-ANDROID-1...6 — presented, none silently resolved (§11.4.66).*